



Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses

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The Union Cabinet during October 2025 approved the Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses- a landmark initiative aimed at boosting domestic production and achieving self-sufficiency (Aatmanirbharta) in pulses.

Scheme duration and financial outlay

The Mission will be implemented over a six-year period, from 2025-26 to 2030-31, with a financial outlay of Rs 11,440 crore.

Scheme background

Pulses hold special importance in India's cropping systems and diets. India is the world's largest producer and consumer of pulses. With rising incomes and standard of living, pulses consumption has increased. However, domestic production has not kept pace with demand, leading to a 15-20% increase in pulse imports. To reduce this import dependency, meet rising demand, maximize

production, and enhance farmers income, a 6-year "Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses" was announced in the FY 2025-26 Budget.

Scheme implementation

- The Mission will adopt a comprehensive strategy covering research, seed systems, area expansion, procurement, and price stability.



- **Seed systems**

- Develop and disseminate latest varieties of pulses which are high in productivity, pest-resistant and climate-resilient. Multi-location trials will be carried out in major pulse-growing states to ensure regional suitability.
- To ensure availability for premium quality seeds, states will prepare five-year rolling seed production plans. The breeder seed production will be supervised by ICAR. Foundation and certified seed production will be done by state and central level agencies, and closely tracked through the Seed Authentication, Traceability & Holistic Inventory (SATHI) portal.
- To make improved varieties widely available, 126 lakh quintals certified seeds will be distributed to pulse-growing farmers, covering 370 lakh hectares by 2030-31.

- **Convergence with other schemes** : This will be complemented by convergence with the soil health programme, Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanization, balanced fertilizer use, plant protection, and extensive demonstrations by ICAR, KVKs, and State Departments to promote best practices.
- **Area expansion** : The Mission seeks to expand the area under pulses by an additional 35 lakh hectares by targeting rice fallow areas and other diversifiable lands, supported by promoting intercropping and crop diversification. For this, 88 lakh seed kit will be distributed free of cost to the farmers.
- **Capacity building of farmers** and seed growers will be taken up through structured training programmes to promote sustainable techniques and modern technologies.
- To **strengthen markets and value chains**, the Mission will help develop post-harvest infrastructure, including 1000 processing units, thereby reducing crop losses, improving value addition, and increasing farmer incomes. A maximum subsidy of Rs. 25 lakhs will be available for setting up of processing, packaging units.
- The Mission will adopt a cluster-based approach, tailoring interventions to the specific needs of each cluster. This will enable more effective allocation of resources, enhance productivity, and promote geographic diversification of pulse production.
- A major feature of the Mission will be assured maximum procurement of Tur, Urad, and Masoor under Price Support Scheme (PSS) of PM-AASHA. NAFED and NCCF will undertake 100% procurement in participating states for the next four years from farmers who register with these agencies and enter into agreements.
- Additionally, to safeguard farmer confidence, the Mission will establish a mechanism for monitoring global pulse prices.

Expected outcomes

By 2030-31, the Mission is expected to expand the area under pulses to 310 lakh hectares, increase production to 350 lakh tonnes, and raise yield to 1130 kg/ha. Alongside productivity gains, the Mission will generate significant employment.

The mission seeks to achieve the goal of Atmanirbharta (self-reliance) in pulses, reduce import dependency and conserve valuable foreign exchange while boosting farmers' incomes. This mission will also accrue significant environmental benefits in the form of climate resilient practices, and improved soil health and making productive use of crop fallow areas.

source:

https://data.vikaspedia.in/short/lc?k=F_sCXj-FgrZHsr1azpA75A

